

D756

Individualized Education Plan (IEP) Collaboration and Communication with Parents and School Staff

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A present levels statement says a third grader reads 38 words correct per minute (grade-level benchmark 83) and answers literal questions well. He enjoys drawing and his family recently got a dog. Which annual goal best connects to the present levels?

- A. By the annual review, he will read grade-3 passages at 70 words correct per minute on 3 of 4 probes.
- B. He will improve in math computation.
- C. He will draw pictures about his dog.
- D. He will answer literal questions with 90% accuracy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

An IEP meeting is set for a fifth grader who spends most of her day in general education. Attending are her mother, a special education teacher who also coaches track, the school psychologist, and the speech therapist. The meeting room was just painted. Who is missing?

- A. The track coach.
- B. No one; the team is complete.
- C. The school nurse.
- D. A general education teacher and a district representative.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which person on the team is responsible for being able to commit district resources?

- A. Any team member.
- B. The parent.
- C. The district (LEA) representative.
- D. The general education teacher.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

The general education teacher, who recently had knee surgery, cannot attend tomorrow's IEP meeting, where the student's progress in her class will be discussed. The meeting is in the library. What is required to excuse her?

- A. A note from her doctor.
- B. A verbal OK from the parent.
- C. Written agreement from the parent and district, plus her written input before the meeting.
- D. Written agreement only; input is never needed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

The speech therapist cannot attend, and speech services will not be discussed or changed. What does excusal require?

- A. Nothing, since speech is not discussed.
- B. A hearing officer's approval.
- C. Written agreement plus written input.
- D. Written agreement of the parent and district.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A student has had an IEP for three years. His parents, who run a family farm, received the procedural safeguards notice when he first qualified. The district now proposes a 15-day suspension that changes his placement. What must the district do?

- A. Give the parents a copy of the procedural safeguards notice now.
- B. Mail it after the farm's busy season.
- C. Nothing; they already got it when he first qualified.
- D. Give it only if the parents ask.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

In a state where the age of majority is 18, a student turns 17 next month. She plans to study nursing and works at a grocery store. Her upcoming IEP meeting is in two weeks. What must the IEP include?

- A. A nursing program application.
- B. Nothing until she turns 18.
- C. A statement that she has been told which rights will transfer to her at 18.
- D. A notice sent only to her parents.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a state where the age of majority is 18, by what age must the student be informed that rights will transfer?

- A. 18
- B. 16
- C. 19
- D. 17

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A family has felt unheard in past IEP meetings. The new meeting is in a conference room with a large window, and the family brought a younger child. How should the case manager open?

- A. Share the student's strengths and invite the family to describe what they see at home and their hopes.
- B. Set up an activity for the younger child.
- C. Review all test scores that show gaps.
- D. Skip introductions to save time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A father says, "Every year you promise progress, and every year he's still behind." The meeting started ten minutes late, and the father works night shifts. What is the best first response?

- A. "We will never let that happen again."
- B. "It sounds like you're frustrated that promises haven't turned into progress. Can you tell me what you'd most like to see?"
- C. "Actually, he has made progress on two goals."
- D. "Sorry we started late; let's move on."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which response is a reflection of feeling?

- A. "You're saying middle school starts in August."
- B. "You seem worried about how she'll handle middle school."
- C. "Many parents feel that way; it's fine."
- D. "Here is our transition plan."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A mother whose home language is Vietnamese attends an IEP meeting. Her 12-year-old daughter offers to interpret. The school recently hired a new counselor, and the meeting is on a Tuesday. What should the team do?

- A. Send the IEP home in English for her to read later.
- B. Provide a qualified interpreter, use plain language instead of acronyms, and check understanding.
- C. Ask the new counselor to interpret.
- D. Let the daughter interpret, since she is fluent.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A present levels statement says a third grader reads 38 words correct per minute (grade-level benchmark 83) and answers literal questions well. ~~He enjoys drawing and his family recently got a dog.~~ Which annual goal best connects to the present levels?

Target word: goal tied to PLAAFP **Decides:** The need named is reading fluency.

A	Correct	Directly targets the fluency need in present levels.
B	Adjacent category	No present-level data support a math goal.
C	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
D	Inverted operation	Targets a strength, not the need.

2. Answer D Concept 2

An IEP meeting is set for a fifth grader who spends most of her day in general education. Attending are her mother, a special education teacher ~~who also coaches track~~, the school psychologist, and the speech therapist. ~~The meeting room was just painted.~~ Who is missing?

Target word: required members **Decides:** Two required roles are absent.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant role.
B	Dropped element	Drops the general education teacher and district representative.
C	Adjacent category	Invited if relevant, not required.
D	Correct	Both are required members.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which person on the team is responsible for being able to commit district resources?

Target word: reverse: from duty to role **Decides:** District representative (LEA).

A	Absolute language	Authority rests with the district representative.
B	Inverted operation	The parent is a decision-maker but cannot commit district resources.
C	Correct	That member must be able to commit resources.
D	Confusion set	Required, but not for resources.

4. Answer C Concept 3

The general education teacher, ~~who recently had knee surgery~~, cannot attend tomorrow's IEP meeting, where the student's progress in her class will be discussed. ~~The meeting is in the library.~~ What is required to excuse her?

Target word: excusal requirements **Decides:** Her area will be discussed.

A	Camouflage	Medical reason does not satisfy the rule.
B	Dropped element	Drops written consent and her input.
C	Correct	Both conditions apply when the area is discussed.
D	Absolute language	Input is needed when her area is discussed.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

The speech therapist cannot attend, and speech services will not be discussed or changed. What does excusal require?

Target word: reverse: area not discussed **Decides:** Only written agreement of parent and district.

A	Dropped element	Written agreement is still required.
B	Adjacent category	Not part of excusal.
C	Confusion set	Input is needed only when the area is discussed.
D	Correct	When the area is not discussed, written agreement suffices.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A student has had an IEP for three years. His parents, ~~who run a family farm,~~ received the procedural safeguards notice when he first qualified. The district now proposes a 15-day suspension that changes his placement. What must the district do?

Target word: notice timing **Decides:** Disciplinary change of placement triggers the notice.

A	Correct	Disciplinary change of placement is a required trigger.
B	Camouflage	Irrelevant timing.
C	Dropped element	Drops the annual and event-based triggers.
D	Adjacent category	Request is one trigger, but discipline requires it anyway.

7. Answer C Concept 5

In a state where the age of majority is 18, a student turns 17 next month. ~~She plans to study nursing and works at a grocery store.~~ Her upcoming IEP meeting is in two weeks. What must the IEP include?

Target word: age-of-majority notice **Decides:** One year before 18.

A	Camouflage	Irrelevant.
B	Inverted operation	Notice must come before, not at, the birthday.
C	Correct	Required at least one year before the age of majority.
D	Dropped element	The student must be informed.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

In a state where the age of majority is 18, by what age must the student be informed that rights will transfer?

Target word: solve for the age **Decides:** One year before 18.

A	Dropped element	Drops the one-year lead time.
B	Confusion set	Confuses with the transition planning age.
C	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting.
D	Correct	$18 - 1 = 17$.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A family has felt unheard in past IEP meetings. ~~The new meeting is in a conference room with a large window, and the family brought a younger child.~~ How should the case manager open?

Target word: meeting opening **Decides:** Start with strengths and family knowledge.

A	Correct	Asset-based openings build trust.
B	Camouflage	Helpful, but not the opening move.
C	Inverted operation	Deficit-first opening.
D	Dropped element	Drops relationship-building.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A father says, "Every year you promise progress, and every year he's still behind." ~~The meeting started ten minutes late, and the father works night shifts.~~ What is the best first response?

Target word: active listening **Decides:** A frustrated parent concern.

A	Absolute language	An unrealistic promise, not listening.
B	Correct	Paraphrase, reflect feeling, open question.
C	Inverted operation	Defends before understanding.
D	Camouflage	Addresses the delay, not the concern.

11. Answer B Concept 7 · transfer

Which response is a reflection of feeling?

Target word: reverse: identify the skill **Decides:** Names the emotion the parent shows.

A	Confusion set	Paraphrase of content, not feeling.
B	Correct	Names the feeling behind the words.
C	Adjacent category	Dismisses the feeling.
D	Dropped element	Solution without listening.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A mother whose home language is Vietnamese attends an IEP meeting. Her 12-year-old daughter offers to interpret. ~~The school recently hired a new counselor, and the meeting is on a Tuesday.~~ What should the team do?

Target word: language access **Decides:** A qualified interpreter is needed.

A	Dropped element	Drops meaningful participation.
B	Correct	Qualified interpreters and plain language ensure meaningful participation.
C	Camouflage	The counselor is not a qualified interpreter.
D	Adjacent category	Children should not interpret sensitive meetings.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	PLAAFP drives the goals	The present levels statement describes current performance with data and how the disability affects progress; every annual goal must connect to a need named there.	Writing goals from a checklist or curriculum list with no link to present levels.	A goal appears that no present-level data support.
2	Required IEP team members	The team includes the parents, at least one general education teacher (if the child is or may be in general education), at least one special education teacher, a district representative who can commit resources, someone who can interpret evaluation results, and the student when appropriate.	Holding the meeting without a general education teacher or a district representative.	"Who must attend?"
3	Excusing a team member	A required member may be excused only with written agreement of the parent and district; if that member's area will be discussed, the member must also submit written input before the meeting.	Excusing a member by a verbal OK or a note from the member alone.	A required member cannot attend.
4	Procedural safeguards notice	The district gives parents the procedural safeguards notice once a year, and also at initial referral or request for evaluation, on the first complaint in a year, on a disciplinary change of placement, and on request.	Thinking it is given only once when the child is first found eligible.	"When must parents receive their rights?"
5	Transfer of rights at the age of majority	At least one year before the student reaches the state's age of majority, the IEP must state that the student has been told which rights will transfer to them.	Telling the student at the birthday itself or telling only the parents.	A student approaching 17 or 18 in an IEP scenario.
6	Asset-based meeting openings	Begin IEP meetings by naming the student's strengths and the family's knowledge and hopes before discussing needs.	Opening with a list of deficits and test scores.	A family that has felt unheard in past meetings.
7	Active listening	Paraphrase what the parent said, reflect the feeling, and ask open questions before offering solutions.	Responding to a concern by immediately explaining or defending the school's view.	A parent expresses frustration or worry.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Culturally responsive, jargon-free communication	Use plain language, qualified interpreters, and respect for the family's values and decision-making norms; check that information is understood.	Using acronyms and asking a child or sibling to interpret.	A family whose home language or culture differs from the school's.

Course scope (public description): Individualized Education Plan (IEP) Collaboration and Communication with Parents and School Staff prepares special education teachers to collaborate effectively with parents, school staff, and other professionals to plan programs and access services for students with exceptionalities. This includes applying culturally responsive communication strategies within school, educational settings, and the community. The course introduces ways to enhance parental involvement and family engagement while teaching families and students advocacy throughout the Individualized Education Plan (IEP) and transition planning processes. The learner will create an IEP and then engage in a simulated IEP annual review where they will practice effective communication and collaboration skills key to the program's development and implementation. Candidates will engage in three hours of preclinical experiences that include a simulated collaborative experience in which skills learned can be applied.